The *New York Times* and *Time* magazine seem to understand better than our own (Israeli) news outlets that Netanyahu has completely lost it and is acting erratically. His juggling act has not a chance of success. He will probably end up a hostage of his extreme-right wing acolytes.

The conversation between representatives of both camps will start tonight in the President's Residence. In principle, this is how it should be, but I remain very skeptical about the coalition's intentions. It is hard to believe that Netanyahu has instructed his delegates to hold a bona fide negotiation with real compromise in mind. Their aim is probably to delay long enough to deflate the mass protests and then to renew the legislative blitz.

I am glad to see that my skepticism is shared by several journalists of *Haaretz* and the leaders of the protest movement. It appears that the coalition went so far as to ask advice from Poland, where mass protests occurred against a judicial "reform" launched in 2015. At some stage the Polish opposition thought it had won, but the negotiations petered out, the opposition was demobilized, and the government renewed its onslaught.

A protest demonstration has been called for Saturday evening, as in all previous weeks. Let's see what happens. Incidentally, the so-called spontaneous counter-demonstration in favor of the overhaul was very well organized ahead of time and the participants were violent when they managed to get at opposition protestors. So much for my theories about Jewish violence. All this will become highly dangerous once Ben-Gvir's private army is set up.

Some new laws will have to wait, but not the law allowing Knesset members and families to contribute donations to Netanyahu. Otherwise, how could impoverished Sara'le pay for her hairdresser and Netanyahu pay for his lobster at the Savoy?

In his press conference, Biden was quite explicit: "Israel cannot go on that way." He added that he was very worried about the situation, like many